the same moral principles of daily living, and since all religions have their own ideas of a god as the ruler of the universe to whom they can psychologically adapt by prayer and worship, what is important is that a non-Hindu be a better follower of his own religion than that he change his religion to that of another place or time, since these historical accidents do not make a religion true or false. The idea in this kind of catholicity and essential identity of all religions is not to demonstrate that the religions of the world do not differ in numerous ways, but only that these differences in themselves are not so important as is their fundamental identity which, if truly followed, makes a man lead a noble life.

Hinduism gives freedom to its adherents in the matter of prayer and worship and in the concept of gods and goddesses in their different aspects. To a Westerner it may be surprising to note that Hinduism has no church and has no ecclesiastical organization. It has no structural administrative unity for the purpose of guiding the religious life of its adherents. Hinduism is not an organized machinery of religiosity which is to take care of the religious life of its followers or spread the religion to outsiders. The Hindu religious precepts are all deeply rooted in the minds and hearts of millions of men and women who follow its pious doctrines, pray, and build temples freely whenever and wherever they like, in any structure and form. They also install their own deities, pray and worship in their own way, and derive their own solace and comfort. This variety and freedom in Hinduism often bewilders foreigners who are unable to calculate the actual number of deities or gods or goddesses in Hinduism. Outsiders have called Hinduism by many names: pantheism, polytheism, and other types of theisms. This, however, does not bother the Hindus who see a subjective and psychologically identical attitude working in religious minds towards their different gods or goddesses. Also, they all have the same moral code for their daily practices. These differences therefore are regarded as external and unimportant and are freely permitted. Actually, the genius of the Hindus through the centuries has been to see and assert the essential unity in the midst of the manifold and necessary diversities and to let the diversities remain where they do not damage the existence and the practical value of the essential unity. The subjective unification of mind and heart is regarded as more important than the objective diversification of practice, which must be the case with human beings in different conditions—accidents of time, place, history, and education. The Hindus have always carried this craze for oneness or unity in the midst of diversity into fields other than religion.